HEALTHCARE HACKATHON

WUHC'S HEALTHCARE HACKATHON IS A TWO-WEEK VIRTUAL COMPETITION THAT BRINGS TOGETHER PASSIONATE HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS TO DESIGN INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS TO REAL-WORLD HEALTHCARE CHALLENGES. PARTICIPANTS WILL WORK INDIVIDUALLY OR IN TEAMS TO DEVELOP EITHER A RESEARCH-DRIVEN PROPOSAL OR A TECHNICAL SOLUTION, CULMINATING IN A FINAL SUBMISSION THAT INCLUDES A WRITTEN PROPOSAL, A VIDEO PITCH, AND A VISUAL SUMMARY.

WHAT IS A 'HEALTHCARE HACKATHON'?

A 'hackathon' is a portmanteau of **'hack'** (by way of exploring novel solutions) and **'marathon'** (for the intense atmosphere over a sustained period of time). The conventional hackathon typically lasts between 24-72 hours and often results in the **development of functioning software or prototypes**.

However, our Healthcare Hackathon is more of an **'ideathon'** - participants create and refine new ideas, but neither websites nor apps are needed (but can be) to submit a project. Thus, no prior coding or programming experience is required!

WHAT ARE WE EXPECTING?

Participants will choose one of three tracks: **AI and Innovation, Cancer, or Social Equity**, and spend 2 weeks developing a **solution to a healthcare problem** within their chosen theme. Projects may range from AI-driven tools and technical prototypes to policy proposals or research-based interventions. Teams will be expected to **demonstrate strong problem understanding, innovation, and feasibility in their work.**

Throughout the hackathon, students will independently research, design, and refine their ideas. Final submissions will include:

- A research proposal or project document (maximum 10 pages)
- A maximum 3 minute recorded video pitch
- A one-slide visual summary (e.g., poster, quad chart, or infographic)

Submissions should be sent with the subject line: **"Submission for 2026 HH | [Team Name] | [List Team Members]".**

TIMELINE

- **March 23:** Challenge Released
- **March 28:** Opening Ceremony
- **March 28** – April 11: Work Period
- **April 1:** Track Confirmation Form Due
- **April 11**: Final Submission Deadline
- **April 12–18:** Judging Period
- **April 19:** Closing Ceremony & Awards

PAST SEASONS

The theme for our Spring 2024 iteration of the WUHC Healthcare Hackathon was **'Value-Based Payment and Revolutionizing Healthcare Financing,'** in which we challenged participants to **reimagine** the payment landscape of healthcare, with emphasis on supporting the goals of **value-based care, improved health outcomes, and enhanced efficiency.**

The theme for our Spring 2025 iteration of the WUHC Healthcare Hackathon was '**Social Determinants of Health and Crises in South Sudan,'** in which we challenged participants to investigate how s**ocial, environmental, and economic factors shape health outcomes,** and how to strategize solutions around these considerations.

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